

Classroom SEL pack, a week on learning from elders, ages 3 to 7

The Old Path Song

A five-day plan with everything to print: word cards, a poster, a feelings chart, sequencing cards, activity cards, promise cards, an observation grid, exit tickets and family letters in five languages. The Home Activity Pack is included at the back.

Classroom licence: one teacher may print and copy this pack for their own class and students' families. Please don't share the file or post it online.

The week at a glance

About 20 to 30 minutes a day. Each day stands alone if you only have time for one.

Day	What you do	Print
Day 1 Read and learn the words	Read the story with the pause points. Teach the five words with gestures. Put up the poster and word cards.	Pages 3, 4, 5
Day 2 Feelings	Feelings check-in. Re-read the book and talk about how the characters felt, using the talk questions.	Pages 6, 9
Day 3 Retell	Mix up the sequencing cards and put the story back in order as a class. Retell with “First… Then… At the end…”.	Page 7
Day 4 Song-map walk	Set out three landmarks in the room or the yard. Sing a short song-map together (‘three round stones, then the big chair…’) and walk it in a line, tapping ka-tum as you g…	Page 8
Day 5 Follow the beat	Follow the beat, then promise cards and exit tickets. Send the family letter home.	Pages 8, 10, 14 to 16

Ontario Kindergarten frames

Belonging and Contributing, Problem Solving and Innovating, Demonstrating Literacy and Mathematics Behaviours, Self-Regulation and Well-Being

Materials

The book (or the class screen), a drum or a box to tap, three stones, chart paper, crayons

Also in this pack

All 12 pages of the Home Activity Pack (from page 17), which you may copy for your class. Book languages: English, French, Spanish, German, Italian.

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Day 1: the read-aloud

Before (3 minutes)

Show the cover. Ask: What kind of animal is this? Have you ever seen one? What do you notice about her scales and her tail? Say: This story is about learning from people who came before us, like grandparents. Who teaches you old songs, games or stories? Take three or four answers. Teach the refrain: tap your knee twice and say ‘Ka-tum, ka-tum.’ Ask the children to tap along every time they hear it.

During: stop, ask, listen (10 minutes)

Spread	What happens	Ask	Listen for
2	Ama loves new paths and games.	What new thing did you try or find this week?	a new game, a new friend, a new food
3	Nana sings her old song; Ama yawns.	Why does Ama think the song is boring?	it is old, she has heard it every night, she likes new things
5	The dry wind comes and Ama can’t remember the song.	How are the animals feeling now? How is Ama feeling?	hungry, worried, sorry she didn’t listen Go further: What could Ama do?
6	Ama decides to go back and fetch the song. Her cheeks felt hot.	What do you think that means?	she feels embarrassed, she is sorry, she wishes she had listened
7	Ama really listens; Nana says the song came from her own Nana.	How old do you think the song is?	very old, older than Nana, from long ago
8	They follow the song’s landmarks; the dust gets thick.	What was the first landmark in the song? Can you remember?	three round stones, then the bent palm, the dry stream
9	Ama taps a beat on her scales so everyone can follow.	Was the beat an old idea or a new idea?	new, it was Ama’s own idea Go further: How did old and new help together?
10	Ama climbs above the dust and spots the fig tree.	Why did climbing help her see?	she was above the dust, she could see far
12	The old song becomes a new clapping game.	What did Ama do with the old song at the end?	made it a game, taught the little ones

Spread numbers match the reader on the class screen. You don’t need every stop.

Handle with care: Some children don’t have grandparents nearby, or have lost one. Widen it to ‘an older person you know’: a neighbour, an aunt, a teacher. More notes on the “For every child” page.

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Word wall cards

Cut out and add to your word wall. Teach each word with its gesture.

path

a little track you walk along

Do it: walk two fingers across your arm

landmark

something you can see that helps you find your way, like a big rock or a tree

Do it: point far away

dusty

full of tiny bits of dry dirt in the air

Do it: wave a hand in front of your face

fetch

to go and get something and bring it back

Do it: reach out and pull back to your chest

beat

a steady sound you can follow, like a drum

Do it: tap ka-tum on your knee

Ka-tum, ka-tum.

Say it together whenever it comes up in the story.

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It’s never too late to go back for what you left behind.

Ka-tum, ka-tum.

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How do you feel today?

Post at circle time. Children clip a peg with their name on a face.
Characters' feelings change during a story, and ours can too.



happy

clip your name here



sad

clip your name here



worried

clip your name here



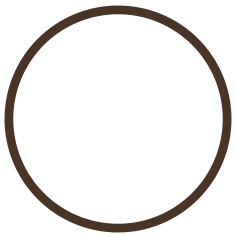
angry

clip your name here



proud

clip your name here



something else

clip your name here

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Sequencing cards

Cut apart for the pocket chart. The four scenes come from the start, two middles and the end of the book, mixed up. Put them in order and retell. Children can color them too.









Answer key, top left to bottom right: 3, 1, 4, 2.

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Activity cards

Cut out and keep with the book. Use one on Day 4 and one on Day 5, or any time.

Song-map walk

15 minutes, Whole class, Materials: Three stones, a chair for the palm, a mat for the stream

Set out three landmarks in the room or the yard. Sing a short song-map together (‘three round stones, then the big chair…’) and walk it in a line, tapping ka-tum as you go. Let a child lead the next walk with new landmarks.

Follow the beat

5 minutes, Whole class, Materials: A drum or a box

Children close their eyes. One child taps ka-tum from a spot in the room; the others point to where the sound comes from. Take turns.

Ask an elder

Home, then 10 minutes in class, Individual, Materials: The family note

Children ask a grandparent or an older person at home for a song, game or saying from when they were little. Share them at circle time and make a class book of ‘old things we still need’.

Science and nature corner

Tree pangolins live in the forests of West and Central Africa, including Ghana. They are covered in hard scales, climb with their tails and eat ants and termites. Pangolins are protected all over the world because people hunt and sell them. Fig trees are a lifesaver for forest animals because they often have fruit when little else does.

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Talk together

Use after reading, at circle time or with a small group. Accept every honest answer.

1. Why did Ama think the old song was boring?

Look for: She loved new things and didn't know the song was useful.

2. How did she feel when she couldn't remember it?

Look for: Worried, sorry, hot-cheeked. Accept any feeling word.

3. What new ideas did Ama add to the old song?

Look for: The beat on her scales, climbing to look, the clapping game.

4. Who in your family knows old songs or stories?

Look for: Any answer. Invite children to bring one in.

5. What would you like to ask a grandparent or an older friend?

Look for: Collect the questions on chart paper to send home.



Say it together

Ka-tum, ka-tum.

The big idea: The old ones know things we still need, and it is never too late to go back and ask.

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Promise cards

Each child writes or draws one way they can show learning from elders this week. Hang them up, then check back on Friday.



I can show learning from elders by

Name _____



I can show learning from elders by

Name _____



I can show learning from elders by

Name _____



I can show learning from elders by

Name _____

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What to look for

Tick what you notice during the week. Each column names the Ontario frame it shows.

Child	Belonging and Contributing	Demonstrating Literacy and Mathematics Behaviours	Problem Solving and Innovating	Self-Regulation and Well-Being	Notes

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Science and place corner

The story takes place in a forest in southern Ghana. We picked Kakum National Park, a protected rainforest near the coast where pangolins, bushbabies, hornbills, duikers and Lowe's monkeys all live.



White-bellied (tree) pangolin

The word pangolin comes from the Malay word penggulung, which means "roller".



Demidoff's dwarf galago (bushbaby)

A Demidoff's galago can leap 1.5 to 2 metres between branches without losing height. Its arms land first, like shock absorbers.



White-bellied pangolin (grandmother)

The baby pangolin rides on the base of its mother's tail while she looks for ants.



Yellow-casqued hornbill

Yellow-casqued hornbills listen to Diana monkeys' alarm calls, and can tell the monkeys' "eagle!" call from their "leopard!" call. That matters: eagles hunt hornbills, but leopards don't.



Maxwell's duikers

Duiker couples rub their heads together, spreading a scent from glands below their eyes. It's like wearing the same perfume!



Lowe's monkeys

At dawn and dusk, the head male climbs high and gives a series of loud booms.

Kakum National Park, Ghana

Ama: Tree pangolins really do climb, roll up and eat only ants and termites. But they mostly come out at night, they live alone, and Ama's golden tail scale and her drumming beat are our story's ideas.

Kwesi: Kwesi's white nose stripe is real: many dwarf galagos have a white stripe down the face. But a real one's tail is long and thin, not bushy, and real galagos mostly eat insects, so a fig would be a treat.

Nana: Real pangolin moms carry their babies on their tail, just as Nana's tail keeps the beat in the story. But real pangolin grandmothers don't live with their families: grown-ups live alone. Nana's song is our story's idea.

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/the-old-path-song

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For every child

English and French learners

Watch the read-aloud first or use the book in the child's home language if we publish it. Teach the five words with their gestures. The refrain is a sound, so everyone can join in from day one.

Children who need more support

Use three stops (spreads 3, 6 and 9). Act out the song-map with real objects before reading so the landmarks make sense.

Mixed ages and older children

Older children make their own song-map of the way from the classroom to the gym or the yard, and teach it to a younger buddy.

Handle with care

Some children don't have grandparents nearby, or have lost one. Widen it to 'an older person you know': a neighbour, an aunt, a teacher.

Keep the hunger in the story gentle: the animals are hungry for a short time and there is plenty for everyone at the end.

Sankofa belongs to the Akan people of Ghana. Present it as their symbol, not as a craft to copy carelessly; if you have Ghanaian families in your class, invite them to share.

Where this value comes from

The Akan people of Ghana have a symbol called Sankofa: a bird that walks forward while looking back, often carrying an egg. It comes from an old saying that it is not wrong to go back for what you have forgotten. The story keeps the idea and adds its other half: Ama brings the old song forward in her own new way.

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Family letters

Cut apart and send home in the family's language, or copy the text into your newsletter.



English

Today we read The Old Path Song, a story about learning from those who came before. Ama the pangolin finds out that her grandmother's old song still holds what everyone needs. At home, ask your child to learn one song, game or saying from an older person in the family. You can watch or read the story together for free at doubleadventure.ca.



Français

Aujourd'hui, nous avons lu une histoire sur ce que nous apprennent ceux qui sont venus avant nous : la petite pangolin découvre que la vieille chanson de sa grand-mère contient ce dont tout le monde a besoin. À la maison, aidez votre enfant à apprendre une chanson, un jeu ou un dicton d'une personne plus âgée de la famille. Vous pouvez lire ou regarder l'histoire gratuitement sur doubleadventure.ca.



Español

Hoy leímos un cuento sobre aprender de quienes vinieron antes: la pequeña pangolín descubre que la vieja canción de su abuela guarda lo que todos necesitan. En casa, ayude a su hijo o hija a aprender una canción, un juego o un dicho de una persona mayor de la familia. Pueden leer o ver el cuento gratis en doubleadventure.ca.

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Family letters

Continued.



Deutsch

Heute haben wir eine Geschichte darüber gelesen, von denen zu lernen, die vor uns kamen: Das kleine Schuppentier entdeckt, dass das alte Lied seiner Großmutter genau das enthält, was alle brauchen. Helfen Sie Ihrem Kind zu Hause, ein Lied, ein Spiel oder einen Spruch von einem älteren Familienmitglied zu lernen. Die Geschichte gibt es kostenlos zum Lesen und Anschauen auf doubleadventure.ca.



Italiano

Oggi abbiamo letto una storia sull'imparare da chi è venuto prima di noi: la piccola pangolina scopre che la vecchia canzone della nonna contiene ciò di cui tutti hanno bisogno. A casa, aiutate vostro figlio o vostra figlia a imparare una canzone, un gioco o un detto da una persona più anziana della famiglia. Potete leggere o guardare la storia gratis su doubleadventure.ca.

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Exit tickets

Read each line aloud. Children tick what they can do and circle a face.
Four tickets per page.

Name _____

Learning from elders: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Learning from elders: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Learning from elders: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Learning from elders: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

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Home activity pack, ages 3 to 7

The Old Path Song

Twelve pages to color, cut, trace, make and talk about, all from the story.
The value in this book: learning from elders.

For use in your own home. Please don't share the file or post it online.

For grown-ups

Read the story first, then pick one page a day. Each page takes 10 to 20 minutes. There are no wrong answers.

The big idea

The old ones know things we still need, and it is never too late to go back and ask.

Say it together

Ka-tum, ka-tum.

Five words from the story

Word	What it means	Do it
path	a little track you walk along	walk two fingers across your arm
landmark	something you can see that helps you find your way, like a big rock or a tree	point far away
dusty	full of tiny bits of dry dirt in the air	wave a hand in front of your face
fetch	to go and get something and bring it back	reach out and pull back to your chest
beat	a steady sound you can follow, like a drum	tap ka-tum on your knee

A gentle note

Some children don't have grandparents nearby, or have lost one. Widen it to 'an older person you know': a neighbour, an aunt, a teacher.

Keep the hunger in the story gentle: the animals are hungry for a short time and there is plenty for everyone at the end.

What you need

Crayons, a pencil, scissors, glue or tape, a few craft sticks or straws, and the book (or read it free on screen at doubleadventure.ca).

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Meet the friends

Cut out each card along the dashed line. Tape a craft stick on the back and you have a puppet. Act out the story!



Ama

White-bellied (tree) pangolin

Loves everything new, and learns to go back



Kwesi

Demidoff's dwarf galago (bushbaby)

Ama's partner for finding new paths



Nana

White-bellied pangolin (grandmother)

Keeps the old song and knows the way



The hornbill

Yellow-casqued hornbill

The big bird who needs the fig tree



The little antelopes

Maxwell's duikers

Hungry little antelopes who follow the beat



The monkey family

Lowe's monkeys

Fig fans in the high branches

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How did they feel?

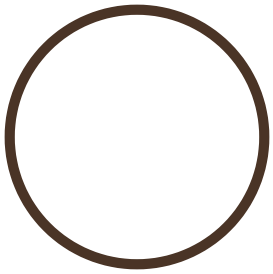
Feelings change during a story. Talk about each moment, then draw how the character felt.

Moment 1

Ama loves new paths and games.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

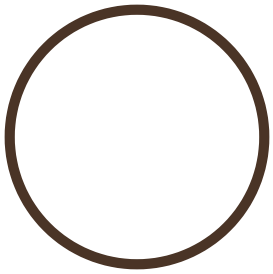


Moment 2

Ama really listens; Nana says the song came from her own Nana.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

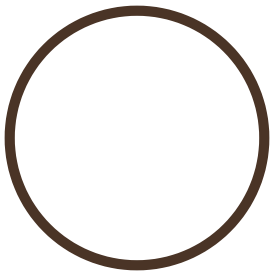


Moment 3

The old song becomes a new clapping game.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm



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Story in order

Color the pictures. Write 1, 2 and 3 in the boxes to show what happened first, next and last. Then cut them out and tell the story.



Color me ☐



Color me ☐



Color me ☐

Tell it in your own words

First, _____

Then, _____

At the end, _____

For grown-ups: the pictures come from the start, the middle and the end of the book. Younger children can just point and tell.

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Trace the words

Trace each word with a pencil. Then try writing it on your own in the empty space.

path a little track you walk along

path path

landmark something you can see that helps you find your way, like a big rock or a tree

landmark landmark

dusty full of tiny bits of dry dirt in the air

dusty dusty

Ama the hero of the story

Ama Ama

Write your name

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Draw your own story

Ama showed learning from elders. Draw a time when you showed learning from elders too, or a time you could.



Tell a grown-up: What happened? How did you feel? How did the other person feel?

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Make and do

Pick one to try today. Each one comes straight from the story.

Ask an elder

You need: The family note

Children ask a grandparent or an older person at home for a song, game or saying from when they were little. Share them at circle time and make a class book of ‘old things we still need’.

Ask an elder

Ask a grandparent or older friend for a song, game or story from when they were little. Learn it, then teach it to someone new.

Make a pangolin

Cut paper scales and glue them on overlapping, like a pinecone. Can your pangolin roll up?

Bushbaby leap

Mark 2 metres on the floor. That's how far a tiny galago leaps between branches!

Draw what you made

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The real animals

The animals in The Old Path Song are based on real ones. Here is something true about each of them.



Ama

White-bellied (tree) pangolin

The word pangolin comes from the Malay word penggulung, which means "roller".



Kwesi

Demidoff's dwarf galago (bushbaby)

A Demidoff's galago can leap 1.5 to 2 metres between branches without losing height. Its arms land first, like shock absorbers.



Nana

White-bellied pangolin (grandmother)

The baby pangolin rides on the base of its mother's tail while she looks for ants.



The hornbill

Yellow-casqued hornbill

Yellow-casqued hornbills listen to Diana monkeys' alarm calls, and can tell the monkeys' "eagle!" call from their "leopard!" call. That matters: eagles hunt hornbills, but leopards don't.

Story or real?

Tree pangolins really do climb, roll up and eat only ants and termites. But they mostly come out at night, they live alone, and Ama's golden tail scale and her drumming beat are our story's ideas.

Where they really live

The story takes place in a forest in southern Ghana. We picked Kakum National Park, a protected rainforest near the coast where pangolins, bushbabies, hornbills, duikers and Lowe's monkeys all live.

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/the-old-path-song

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Color the story

Color this page from the book. What is happening here?



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Talk together cards

Cut out the cards and keep them in a jar. Pull one out at dinner, in the car or at bedtime.

What kind of animal is this? Have you ever seen one? What do you notice about her scales and her tail?

The Old Path Song, talk card 1

Why did Ama think the old song was boring?

The Old Path Song, talk card 2

How did she feel when she couldn't remember it?

The Old Path Song, talk card 3

What new ideas did Ama add to the old song?

The Old Path Song, talk card 4

Who in your family knows old songs or stories?

The Old Path Song, talk card 5

What would you like to ask a grandparent or an older friend?

The Old Path Song, talk card 6

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Learning from elders hero

This is to say that

_____

showed learning from elders, just like Ama.

Ka-tum, ka-tum.

Signed _____ Date _____

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